

Cramér-Rao Bound Optimization for Joint Radar-Communication Beamforming

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Abstract—In this paper, we propose multi-input multi-output (MIMO) beamforming designs towards joint radar sensing and multi-user communications. We employ the Cramér-Rao bound (CRB) as a performance metric of target estimation, under both point and extended target scenarios. We then propose minimizing the CRB of radar sensing while guaranteeing a pre-defined level of signal-to-interference-plus-noise ratio (SINR) for each communication user. For the single-user scenario, we derive a closed form for the optimal solution for both cases of point and extended targets. For the multi-user scenario, we show that both problems can be relaxed into semidefinite programming by using the semidefinite relaxation approach, and prove that the global optimum can be generally obtained. Finally, we demonstrate numerically that the globally optimal solutions are reachable via the proposed methods, which provide significant gains in target estimation performance over state-of-the-art benchmarks.

Index Terms—Dual-functional radar-communication, joint beamforming, Cramér-Rao bound, semidefinite relaxation, successive convex approximation.

I. INTRODUCTION

WIRELESS sensors and communication systems have shaped modern society in profound ways. 5G and beyond network is envisioned as an enabler for many emerging

applications, such as intelligent connected vehicles and remote health-care. These applications demand wireless connectivity with tremendously increased data rates, substantially reduced latency, high-accuracy localization capability and support for massive devices [1], [2]. Indeed, in many location-aware services and applications, sensing and communications are recognized as a pair of intertwined functionalities, which are often required to operate simultaneously [3]–[5].

To reduce costs and improve spectral-, energy-, and hardware-efficiency, the need for joint design of sensing and communication systems naturally arises in the above-mentioned scenarios [6]–[15]. The integration between radar sensors and communication systems has received considerable attention from both industry and academia, motivating research on *Dual-functional Radar-Communication (DFRC) Systems* [8]–[17]. DFRC techniques combine both radar sensing and wireless communications via shared use of the spectrum, the hardware platform and a joint signal processing framework [3], [16].

One of the major challenges in DFRC is the design of a joint waveform, capable of the dual functionalities of target sensing and information delivering. The design methodology can be generally split into three categories: radar-centric design, communication-centric design, and joint design. Radar-centric approaches are built on the basis of a radar probing signal, which dates back to the early work [18], where the communication data are modulated onto the radar pulses by pulse interval modulation (PIM). In this spirit, one may also design a DFRC waveform by using a radar probing signal as an information carrier. Such examples include the combination of amplitude/phase shift keying (ASK/PSK) and linear frequency modulation (LFM) signals [19], [20]. Communication-centric schemes rely on existing communication waveforms and standard-compatible protocols. For instance, the seminal work of [21] proposed employing orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) for the use of target detection. The Doppler and delay processing for radar targets are decoupled in OFDM signals, and can be performed by the classical Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) and its inverse.

More relevant to this work, the DFRC waveform can be designed via jointly considering both functionalities, rather than based on existing radar or communication waveforms [8], [11]. Thanks to the higher degrees-of-freedom (DoFs) brought by multi-antenna arrays, these techniques have been well-explored recently from a spatial-domain perspective. Pioneered by [9], the authors proposed to embed the communication data by varying the sidelobes of the spatial beampattern of the MIMO radar, where the mainlobe is exploited solely for target detection.

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Again, the communication symbols can be expressed in the form of various modulation formats, including ASK and PSK [9], [10]. However, such an approach supports only line-of-sight (LoS) communications, since the communication receivers must be within the correct sidelobe region in order to receive the symbols. To exploit both spatial and frequency diversity, one can embed communication data into the MIMO radar waveform through index or spatial modulation schemes [14], [15], which are capable of tackling more complex non-LoS (NLoS) communication channels.

The above-mentioned approaches are generally categorized as inter-pulse modulation schemes, which represent one communication codeword by a single radar pulse, and, consequently, result in low data rate tied to the pulse repetition frequency (PRF) of the radar. To improve communication performance, the work of [12] proposed a beamforming design tailored for joint target sensing and multi-user NLoS communications, where the data symbols can be accommodated in each of the radar fast-time snapshots. As a step further, [13] proposed a number of DFRC waveform optimization approaches, with minimizing the multi-user interference (MUI) as the objective function given specific radar constraints.

To further exploit the spatial DoFs, massive MIMO arrays, which are at the core of the 5G physical layer, have also been exploited for DFRC design. It has been shown by asymptotic analysis that when the size of the antenna array is sufficiently large, the target can be detected using only a single fast-time snapshot [22]. Together with the use of mmWave and hybrid analog-digital beamforming techniques, the radar sensing functionality can be incorporated into the massive MIMO base station (BS) [16], [23], [24], which may be deployed in the 5G/B5G vehicular network as a road side unit (RSU) for both vehicular communication and localization [25].

While existing DFRC signalling strategies achieve favorable performance tradeoffs between radar and communications, they typically focus on the transmitter design, rather than on optimizing an overall performance metric. More precisely, the target estimation performance for DFRC systems, which is characterized at the receiver side, is guaranteed implicitly by waveform shaping constraints, e.g., to approach some well-designed radar waveforms/beampatterns that are featured with good estimation capability under communication constraints [11]–[13]. To the best of our knowledge, explicit optimization of estimation performance metrics has not been systematically studied in the context of DFRC design.

In this paper, we propose a design framework for multi-user MIMO (MU-MIMO) DFRC beamforming, with a specific emphasis on optimization of the target estimation performance, measured by the CRB for unbiased estimators [26]. We consider two types of target models: point target and extended target, and derive the corresponding CRB expressions as functions of the beamforming matrix. We then formulate optimization problems to minimize the CRB, subject to individual SINR constraints for the users as well as a transmit power budget. Since the resulting formulations of the beamforming designs are non-convex, we propose semidefinite relaxation (SDR) approaches to solve them. We analyze the structure of both problems when there

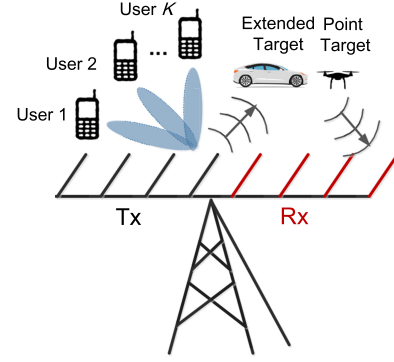


Fig. 1. Dual-functional Radar-Communication System.

is only a single communication user, and derive the optimal closed-form solution. To find the exact global optimum for general multi-user cases, we analyze the rank property of the attained solutions, and rigorously prove that rank-one solutions can be obtained in general for both problems. Finally, we provide numerical results to validate the performance of the proposed approaches. Simulations demonstrate that our designed beamformers significantly outperform the beampattern approximation based DFRC designs by reducing estimation errors.

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows. Section II introduces the system model. Section III derives the CRB for both point and extended target estimation. Section IV and V discuss the joint beamforming design for point and extended target scenarios, respectively. Section VI presents numerical results. Finally, Section VII concludes the paper.

Notations: Matrices are denoted by bold uppercase letters (i.e., $\mathbf{H}$), vectors are represented by bold lowercase letters (i.e., $\mathbf{w}$), and scalars are denoted by normal font (i.e., L); $\text{tr}(\cdot)$ and $\text{vec}(\cdot)$ denote the trace and the vectorization operations, $(\cdot)^T$, $(\cdot)^H$, and $(\cdot)^*$ stand for transpose, Hermitian transpose, and complex conjugate of the matrices. We use $\text{Re}(\cdot)$ and $\text{Im}(\cdot)$ to denote the real and imaginary parts of the argument. l_2 norm and the Frobenius norm are written as $\|\cdot\|$ and $\|\cdot\|_F$.

II. SYSTEM MODEL

A. System Setting

We consider a MIMO DFRC BS equipped with N_t transmit antennas and N_r receive antennas, which is serving K downlink single-antenna users while detecting a single target, as depicted in Fig. 1. For multi-user communications, we set $K \leq N_t$ to guarantee the feasibility of the beamforming design. For MIMO radar estimation tasks, one typically needs $N_t < N_r$, i.e., the receive antenna number should be greater than the transmit antenna number to avoid information loss of the sensed targets. We therefore assume $K \leq N_t < N_r$ throughout the paper.

Let $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times L}$ be a narrowband DFRC signal matrix, with $L > N_t$ being the length of the radar pulse/communication frame. From a communication perspective, $x_{i,j}$, i.e., the (i, j) -th entry of $\mathbf{X}$, represents the discrete signal sample transmitted at the i -th antenna and the j -th time slot. For the radar, $x_{i,j}$ is the j -th fast-time snapshot transmitted at the i -th antenna. In practice, $x_{i,j}$ needs to be associated with a sub-pulse or

a pulse-shaping filter in order to formulate a continuous-time signal.

By transmitting $\mathbf{X}$ to K users, the received signal matrix at communication receivers is

$$\mathbf{Y}_C = \mathbf{H}\mathbf{X} + \mathbf{Z}_C, \quad (1)$$

where $\mathbf{Z}_C \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times L}$ is an AWGN matrix with the variance of each entry being σ_C^2 , and $\mathbf{H} = [\mathbf{h}_1, \mathbf{h}_2, \dots, \mathbf{h}_K]^H \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times N_t}$ represents the communication channel matrix, which is assumed to be known to the BS, with each entry being independently distributed. The matrix $\mathbf{X}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{X} = \mathbf{W}_{DF}\mathbf{S}_C, \quad (2)$$

where $\mathbf{W}_{DF}$ is the dual-functional beamforming matrix to be designed, and $\mathbf{S}_C \in \mathbb{C}^{K \times L}$ contains K unit-power data streams intended for the K users. The data streams are assumed to be independent with each other so that

$$\frac{1}{L}\mathbf{S}_C\mathbf{S}_C^H \approx \mathbf{I}_K. \quad (3)$$

Condition (3) holds asymptotically for, e.g., white Gaussian signaling, provided that the block length L is sufficiently large.

By transmitting $\mathbf{X}$ to sense the target, the reflected echo signal matrix at the receiver of the DFRC BS is given by

$$\mathbf{Y}_R = \mathbf{G}\mathbf{X} + \mathbf{Z}_R, \quad (4)$$

where $\mathbf{Z}_R \in \mathbb{C}^{N_r \times L}$ denotes an additive white Gaussian noise (AWGN) matrix, with variance of each entry being σ_R^2 , and $\mathbf{G} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_r \times N_t}$ represents the target response matrix [27]. The matrix $\mathbf{G}$ can be of different forms depending on the specific target models. In particular, we will consider the following two scenarios:

- 1) *Point target*: In this case, the target is modeled as an unstructured point that is far away from the BS, e.g., a UAV. The target response matrix can be written as

$$\mathbf{G} = \alpha \mathbf{b}(\theta) \mathbf{a}^H(\theta) \triangleq \alpha \mathbf{A}(\theta), \quad (5)$$

where $\alpha \in \mathbb{C}$ represents the reflection coefficient, which contains both the round-trip path-loss and the radar cross-section (RCS) of the target, θ is the azimuth angle of the target relative to the BS, and finally $\mathbf{a}(\theta) \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times 1}$ and $\mathbf{b}(\theta) \in \mathbb{C}^{N_r \times 1}$ are steering vectors of the transmit and receive antennas, respectively. Note that we consider a monostatic radar setting, thereby the direction of arrival (DoA) and the direction of departure (DoD) are the same.

- 2) *Extended target*: In this case, the target is typically modeled as a surface with a large number of distributed point-like scatterers, such as a vehicle or a pedestrian moving on the road. Consequently, $\mathbf{G}$ can be further expressed as

$$\mathbf{G} = \sum_{i=1}^{N_s} \alpha_i \mathbf{b}(\theta_i) \mathbf{a}^H(\theta_i), \quad (6)$$

where N_s is the number of scatterers, α_i and θ_i denote the reflection coefficient and the angle of the i -th scatterer. Due to the narrowband setting, we consider only the angular spread of the target, and assume that all the point-like scatterers are located in the same range bin.

Below we elaborate on the radar and communication performance metrics for both point and extended target scenarios. In particular, we rely on the CRB for target estimation, which is a lower bound on the variance of unbiased estimators, and employ the per-user SINR to measure the communication quality-of-service (QoS).

B. Performance Metrics for the Point Target Case

For the point target case, the CRB for θ was derived in [26], [28], and is given by (7) at the bottom of this page, where

$$\mathbf{R}_X = \frac{1}{L}\mathbf{X}\mathbf{X}^H = \frac{1}{L}\mathbf{W}_{DF}\mathbf{S}_C\mathbf{S}_C^H\mathbf{W}_{DF}^H \approx \mathbf{W}_{DF}\mathbf{W}_{DF}^H \quad (8)$$

is the sample covariance matrix of $\mathbf{X}$, and $\dot{\mathbf{A}}(\theta) = \frac{\partial \mathbf{A}(\theta)}{\partial \theta}$. We note again that the approximation in (8) becomes accurate when the block length L is sufficiently large. Without loss of generality, we will treat this approximation as an accurate equality in the rest of the paper.

While $\text{CRB}(\theta)$ depends on the value of θ as can be seen in (1), minimizing $\text{CRB}(\theta)$ can be interpreted as optimizing $\mathbf{W}_{DF}$ with respect to a direction of interest, where there might be a potential target with azimuth angle of θ . This is typical in the target tracking scenario where the radar wishes to beamform towards an estimated/predicted direction to track the movement of the target. Note that if the target is static or slowly moving, the solution of the beamforming optimization may also vary slowly, in which case an estimated/predicted direction is sufficient for the beamforming design. For these reasons, we assume that θ is fixed in the optimization problem, as will be detailed in Sec. III.

By denoting the beamforming matrix as $\mathbf{W}_{DF} = [\mathbf{w}_1, \mathbf{w}_2, \dots, \mathbf{w}_K]$, with the k -th column being the beamformer for the k -th user, its SINR is given as

$$\gamma_k = \frac{|\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_k|^2}{\sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K |\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_i|^2 + \sigma_C^2}. \quad (9)$$

C. Performance Metrics for the Extended Target Case

For the extended target case, the BS has no prior knowledge about the number and the corresponding angles of scatterers, as the echoes can be randomly reflected in each of the radar's illuminations. Therefore, we resort to estimating the response matrix $\mathbf{G}$ instead of estimating all θ_i . If needed, one can later employ sophisticated signal processing algorithms to extract further information from $\mathbf{G}$.

For example, if N_s paths are resolvable, then the angle and reflection coefficients of each point scatterer can be extracted from the estimate of $\mathbf{G}$ using MUSIC and APES algorithms [29], [30]. If $N_s \geq \text{rank}(\mathbf{G})$, on the other hand, the scattering paths contained in $\mathbf{G}$ might not be resolvable. One may then consider to resolve the dominating paths.

According to the discussion above, in the extended target case we choose $\mathbf{G}$ as a parameter to be estimated, instead of estimating the scatterer angles directly. In this case, (4) is a linear

$$\text{CRB}(\theta) = \frac{\sigma_R^2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H(\theta)\mathbf{A}(\theta)\mathbf{R}_X)}{2|\alpha|^2 L \left(\text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H(\theta)\dot{\mathbf{A}}(\theta)\mathbf{R}_X) - |\text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H(\theta)\mathbf{A}(\theta)\mathbf{R}_X)|^2 \right)}. \quad (7)$$

white Gaussian model in $\mathbf{G}$. By vectorizing (4) we have

$$\tilde{\mathbf{y}}_R = \text{vec}(\mathbf{Y}_R) = (\mathbf{X}^T \otimes \mathbf{I}_{N_r}) \tilde{\mathbf{g}} + \tilde{\mathbf{z}}_R, \quad (10)$$

where $\tilde{\mathbf{g}} = \text{vec}(\mathbf{G})$, and $\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_R = \text{vec}(\mathbf{Z}_R)$. The Fisher Information Matrix (FIM) with respect to $\tilde{\mathbf{g}}$ is known to be [26], [31]

$$\mathbf{J} = \frac{1}{\sigma_R^2} \mathbf{X}^* \mathbf{X}^T \otimes \mathbf{I}_{N_r} = \frac{L}{\sigma_R^2} \mathbf{R}_X^T \otimes \mathbf{I}_{N_r}. \quad (11)$$

By examining (2) we see that $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times L}$ is rank-deficient, since

$$\begin{aligned} \text{rank}(\mathbf{X}) &\leq \min\{\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_{DF}), \text{rank}(\mathbf{S}_C)\} \\ &= K < N_t \leq L. \end{aligned} \quad (12)$$

Consequently, if we transmit only K signal streams, the DoFs available are not enough to recover the rank- N_t matrix $\mathbf{G}$. Moreover, the FIM $\mathbf{J}$ becomes singular, resulting in the non-existence of the unbiased estimator according to [31], [32]. Note that this is not an issue in the point-target scenario, in which case K DoFs are more than enough to estimate θ . For the extended target scenario, one may constrain $\mathbf{G}$ into some subset, and employ a modified CRB [31]. This, however, leads to inevitable performance loss for target estimation, due to the lack of radar DoFs.

In order to guarantee satisfactory radar performance, we propose introducing extra structure to $\mathbf{X}$ for extending the DoFs to its maximum, i.e., N_t , by transmitting dedicated probing streams in addition to data streams intended for K users. Note that these signal streams are dedicated to target probing, without carrying communication data. Let us consider an augmented data matrix, given as

$$\tilde{\mathbf{S}} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{S}_C \\ \mathbf{S}_A \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{C}^{(K+N_t) \times L}, \quad (13)$$

where $\mathbf{S}_A \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times L}$ denotes the dedicated probing streams, and is orthogonal to $\mathbf{S}_C$. Therefore, for sufficiently large L , it still holds true that

$$\frac{1}{L} \tilde{\mathbf{S}} \tilde{\mathbf{S}}^H = \mathbf{I}_{K+N_t}. \quad (14)$$

We further augment the beamforming matrix in the form of $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF} = [\mathbf{w}_1, \mathbf{w}_2, \dots, \mathbf{w}_{K+N_t}] = [\mathbf{V}_C, \mathbf{V}_A] \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times (K+N_t)}$, (15) where $\mathbf{V}_C = [\mathbf{w}_1, \dots, \mathbf{w}_K] \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times K}$ is the communication beamformer, and $\mathbf{V}_A = [\mathbf{w}_{K+1}, \dots, \mathbf{w}_{K+N_t}] \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times N_t}$ is the auxiliary beamforming matrix for the probing streams. By properly designing $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF}$, the resulting transmitted signal matrix $\mathbf{X} = \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF} \tilde{\mathbf{S}}$ will have a full rank of N_t . Note that in this DFRC signal model, the overall beamformer $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF}$ is used for sensing the extended target, for guaranteeing the estimation performance and the feasibility of unbiased estimation. The first K columns of $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF}$, i.e., $\mathbf{V}_C$, convey information data to K users.

Based on the above, the sample covariance matrix of $\mathbf{X}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{R}_X = \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF} \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF}^H = \mathbf{V}_C \mathbf{V}_C^H + \mathbf{V}_A \mathbf{V}_A^H, \quad (16)$$

which has a full rank of N_t and is now invertible. By recalling (11), the CRB for $\mathbf{G}$ (also for its vectorization $\tilde{\mathbf{g}}$) can be expressed as

$$\text{CRB}(\mathbf{G}) = \text{tr}(\mathbf{J}^{-1}) = \frac{\sigma_R^2 N_r}{L} \text{tr}(\mathbf{R}_X^{-1}). \quad (17)$$

The CRB above is achievable using maximum likelihood estimation (MLE). This is because the MLE of $\mathbf{G}$ is simply a linear estimation problem in the presence of the i.i.d. Gaussian noise, whose mean squared error (MSE) equals the CRB.

Note that the dedicated probing signals cause interference to the communication users, as $\mathbf{S}_A$ does not contain any useful information. The per-user SINR expression for the extended target case should therefore be modified as

$$\tilde{\gamma}_k = \frac{|\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_k|^2}{\sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K |\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_i|^2 + \|\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{V}_A\|^2 + \sigma_C^2}, \quad (18)$$

where the radar interference is imposed in (18) as part of the denominator.

III. JOINT BEAMFORMING DESIGN FOR POINT TARGET

A. Problem Formulation

For the point target scenario with fixed θ , the beamforming optimization problem under communication user's SINR and power budget constraints is formulated as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\mathbf{W}_{DF}} \quad & \text{CRB}(\theta) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \gamma_k \geq \Gamma_k, \forall k, \\ & \|\mathbf{W}_{DF}\|_F^2 \leq P_T, \end{aligned} \quad (19)$$

where Γ_k is the required SINR level for the k -th user, and P_T is the transmit power budget.

In what follows, we analyze problem (19) under both single- and multi-user scenarios.

B. Single-User Case

In this subsection, we provide a closed-form solution to problem (19) when there is only a single user. First of all, let us choose the center of the ULA antennas as the reference point, in which case the transmit steering vector and its derivative can be written as (assuming even number of antennas) [28]

$$\mathbf{a}(\theta) = \left[e^{-j \frac{N_t-1}{2} \pi \sin \theta}, e^{-j \frac{N_t-3}{2} \pi \sin \theta}, \dots, e^{j \frac{N_t-1}{2} \pi \sin \theta} \right]^T, \quad (20)$$

$$\dot{\mathbf{a}}(\theta) = \left[-j a_1 \frac{N_t-1}{2} \pi \cos \theta, \dots, j a_{N_t} \frac{N_t-1}{2} \pi \cos \theta \right]^T, \quad (21)$$

where a_i represents the i -th entry of $\mathbf{a}(\theta)$. The receive steering vector and its derivative take similar forms of (20) and (21). It can be easily verified that due to the symmetry,

$$\mathbf{a}^H \dot{\mathbf{a}} = 0, \mathbf{b}^H \dot{\mathbf{b}} = 0, \forall \theta, \quad (22)$$

where $\mathbf{a}$, $\mathbf{b}$, $\dot{\mathbf{a}}$, and $\dot{\mathbf{b}}$ denote $\mathbf{a}(\theta)$, $\mathbf{b}(\theta)$, $\dot{\mathbf{a}}(\theta)$, and $\dot{\mathbf{b}}(\theta)$, respectively. By letting $\mathbf{w}_1$, $\mathbf{h}_1$, and Γ_1 be the beamforming vector, channel, and required SINR threshold in the single-user case, we have $\mathbf{R}_X = \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H$. Leveraging the orthogonality property (22) yields

$$\begin{aligned} \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{b} \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H \mathbf{a} \mathbf{b}^H) = \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 |\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2, \\ \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{b} \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H (\dot{\mathbf{a}} \mathbf{b}^H + \mathbf{a} \dot{\mathbf{b}}^H)) \\ &= \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H \dot{\mathbf{a}}, \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) &= \text{tr}\left(\left(\dot{\mathbf{b}} \mathbf{a}^H + \mathbf{b} \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H\right) \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H \left(\mathbf{a} \dot{\mathbf{b}}^H + \dot{\mathbf{a}} \mathbf{b}^H\right)\right) \\ &= \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 |\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2 + \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 |\dot{\mathbf{a}}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2, \end{aligned} \quad (23)$$

where $\mathbf{A} \triangleq \mathbf{A}(\theta)$, $\dot{\mathbf{A}} \triangleq \dot{\mathbf{A}}(\theta)$. Substituting (23) into (7), CRB(θ) can be simplified to

$$\text{CRB}(\theta) = \frac{\sigma_R^2}{2|\alpha|^2 L \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 |\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2}. \quad (24)$$

The optimization problem (19) can be recast as

$$\begin{aligned} \max_{\mathbf{w}_1} & |\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2 \\ \text{s.t.} & |\mathbf{h}_1^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2 \geq \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \|\mathbf{w}_1\|^2 \leq P_T. \end{aligned} \quad (25)$$

Thus, the CRB minimization problem reduces to maximizing the radiation power at angle θ .

We note that problem (25) can be found in a similar form in a number of existing studies on beamforming design, e.g., in [33], in which the problem is solved by SDR, followed by a rigorous proof of the SDR tightness. As a step further to [33], we show that problem (25) admits a closed-form optimal solution by proving the following lemma and theorem.

Lemma 1: The optimal solution of (25) satisfies

$$\mathbf{w}_1 \in \text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}. \quad (26)$$

Proof: See Appendix A. ■

Using Lemma 1, the optimal solution to (25) is given by the following theorem.

Theorem 1: The optimal solution to (25) is

$$\mathbf{w}_1 = \begin{cases} \sqrt{P_T} \frac{\mathbf{a}}{\|\mathbf{a}\|}, & \text{if } P_T |\mathbf{h}_1^H \mathbf{a}|^2 > N_t \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \\ x_1 \mathbf{u}_1 + x_2 \mathbf{a}_u, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \quad (27)$$

where

$$\mathbf{u}_1 = \frac{\mathbf{h}_1}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|}, \quad \mathbf{a}_u = \frac{\mathbf{a} - (\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{a}) \mathbf{u}_1}{\|\mathbf{a} - (\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{a}) \mathbf{u}_1\|}, \quad (28)$$

$$x_1 = \sqrt{\frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \frac{\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{a}}{|\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{a}|}}, \quad x_2 = \sqrt{P_T - \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \frac{\mathbf{a}_u^H \mathbf{a}}{|\mathbf{a}_u^H \mathbf{a}|}}. \quad (29)$$

Proof: See Appendix B. ■

C. Semidefinite Relaxation for the Multi-User Case

By taking a closer look at (7), we see that CRB(θ) as an objective function is non-convex in $\mathbf{R}_X$ due to its fractional structure. Fortunately, it can be equivalently transformed into a convex expression with respect to $\mathbf{R}_X$ by relying on the following proposition.

Proposition 1: Minimizing CRB(θ) is equivalent to solving the following SDP

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\mathbf{R}_X \succeq \mathbf{0}, t} & -t \\ \text{s.t.} & \begin{bmatrix} \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) - t & \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) & \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \end{bmatrix} \succeq \mathbf{0}. \end{aligned} \quad (30)$$

Proof: The proof is a straightforward application of the Schur complement condition [34]. ■

Based on Proposition 1, and by noting that $\mathbf{R}_X = \mathbf{W}_{DF} \mathbf{W}_{DF}^H = \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{w}_k \mathbf{w}_k^H$, problem (19) can be rewritten as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\{\mathbf{w}_k\}_{k=1}^K, \mathbf{R}_X, t} & -t \\ \text{s.t.} & \begin{bmatrix} \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) - t & \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) & \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \end{bmatrix} \succeq \mathbf{0}, \\ & \frac{|\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_k|^2}{\sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K |\mathbf{h}_k^H \mathbf{w}_i|^2 + \sigma_C^2} \geq \Gamma_k, \forall k, \\ & \sum_{k=1}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{w}_k \mathbf{w}_k^H) \leq P_T, \quad \mathbf{R}_X = \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{w}_k \mathbf{w}_k^H. \end{aligned} \quad (31)$$

While problem (31) is still non-convex, it can be relaxed into a convex problem by using the classical SDR technique. Upon letting $\mathbf{Q}_k = \mathbf{h}_k \mathbf{h}_k^H$, $\mathbf{W}_k = \mathbf{w}_k \mathbf{w}_k^H$, the k -th SINR constraint can be reformulated as

$$\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_i) \geq \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2. \quad (32)$$

Note that the desired solution requires $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1$, and $\mathbf{W}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}$. By dropping the rank constraints on $\mathbf{W}_k, \forall k$, (31) is relaxed to

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\{\mathbf{W}_k\}_{k=1}^K, t} & -t \\ \text{s.t.} & \begin{bmatrix} \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k) - t & \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \mathbf{A} \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k) \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k) & \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k) \end{bmatrix} \succeq \mathbf{0}, \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_i) \geq \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2, \forall k,$$

$$\sum_{k=1}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{W}_k) \leq P_T, \mathbf{W}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k, \quad (33)$$

which is a standard SDP and can be solved via numerical tools like CVX [35].

To show the achievability of rank-one optimal solutions, we provide further insights into problem (33) by proving the following theorem.

Theorem 2: Suppose that problem (33) is feasible. Let $\bar{\mathbf{A}} = [\mathbf{a}, \dot{\mathbf{a}}]$. Under the condition that $\mathbf{H} \bar{\mathbf{A}}$ is of full column rank, the optimal solution $\{\mathbf{W}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ always satisfies $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1, \forall k$.

Proof: See Appendix C. ■

Since we consider a random channel $\mathbf{H}$ whose entries are independently distributed, the condition that $\mathbf{H} \bar{\mathbf{A}}$ is of full column rank almost always holds for $K \geq 2$. Therefore, solving (33) yields rank-one solutions in general, i.e., the globally optimal solutions of (31).

We remark that while ULA is considered in the system setting, the analysis for the single-user case holds for any symmetric array geometries that satisfy (22). Moreover, as observed in (33), the multi-user problem formulation does not rely on the specific form of the steering matrix $\mathbf{A}(\theta)$. As a consequence,

the analysis for the multi-user case can be straightforwardly extended to arbitrary array geometries, including symmetric and asymmetric ones.

IV. JOINT BEAMFORMING DESIGN FOR EXTENDED TARGET

A. Problem Formulation

Based on the discussion in Sec. II-C, as well as (16) and (17), the beamforming optimization problem for the extended target scenario can be expressed as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\mathbf{W}_{DF}} \quad & \text{CRB}(\mathbf{G}) = \text{tr} \left((\mathbf{V}_C \mathbf{V}_C^H + \mathbf{V}_A \mathbf{V}_A^H)^{-1} \right) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \tilde{\gamma}_k \geq \Gamma_k, k = 1, \dots, K, \quad \left\| \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF} \right\|_F^2 \leq P_T. \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

By letting

$$\mathbf{W}_k = \mathbf{w}_k \mathbf{w}_k^H, \forall k \leq K, \quad \mathbf{W}_{K+1} = \mathbf{V}_A \mathbf{V}_A^H, \quad (35)$$

and following similar steps to the point target counterpart, (34) can be relaxed to the following convex form

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\{\mathbf{W}_k\}_{k=1}^{K+1}} \quad & \text{tr} \left(\left(\sum_{k=1}^{K+1} \mathbf{W}_k \right)^{-1} \right) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^{K+1} \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_i) \geq \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2, \forall k, \\ & \sum_{k=1}^{K+1} \text{tr}(\mathbf{W}_k) \leq P_T, \mathbf{W}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k. \end{aligned} \quad (36)$$

Next, we show that problem (36) can be solved in closed form when there is only a single communication user to be served.

B. Single-User Case

Let us denote the SINR threshold, covariance matrix of the channel vector, and beamformer for the single user as Γ_1 , $\mathbf{Q}_1 = \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H$, and $\mathbf{W}_1 = \mathbf{w}_1 \mathbf{w}_1^H$, respectively. The optimization problem (36) can be recast as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\mathbf{W}_1, \mathbf{R}_X} \quad & \text{tr}(\mathbf{R}_X^{-1}) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_1 \mathbf{W}_1) - \Gamma_1 \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_1 (\mathbf{R}_X - \mathbf{W}_1)) \geq \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \\ & \text{tr}(\mathbf{R}_X) \leq P_T, \mathbf{R}_X \succeq \mathbf{W}_1 \succeq \mathbf{0}. \end{aligned} \quad (37)$$

In this case we have $\mathbf{R}_X = \mathbf{W}_1 + \mathbf{W}_2$, where $\mathbf{W}_2 = \mathbf{V}_A \mathbf{V}_A^H$.

Lemma 2: Let $\mathbf{u}_1 = \frac{\mathbf{h}_1}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|}$. Then $\mathbf{u}_1$ is an eigenvector of the optimal $\mathbf{R}_X$ of problem (37).

Proof: Suppose that (37) is feasible. Given an optimal $\mathbf{R}_X$ that reaches the minimum, one can always construct an optimal $\mathbf{W}_1$ of the form

$$\mathbf{W}_1 = (\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{u}_1) \mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^H. \quad (38)$$

This is because by (38) we project $\mathbf{R}_X$ onto the direction of $\mathbf{h}_1$, in which case $\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_1 \mathbf{W}_1)$ is maximized, and the interference term is minimized to zero. Accordingly, the SINR is maximized, while the objective value and the transmit power remain unchanged. Therefore, (38) is a solution to (37).

It can be immediately observed that the optimal $\mathbf{W}_2$ is orthogonal to $\mathbf{W}_1$, which indicates that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_2) \leq N_t - 1$. To

guarantee that $\mathbf{R}_X$ is invertible, it holds true that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_2) \geq N_t - 1$. This suggests $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_2) = N_t - 1$. Let us consider the eigenvalue decomposition of $\mathbf{W}_2$, which is

$$\mathbf{W}_2 = \bar{\mathbf{U}} \bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \bar{\mathbf{U}}^H, \quad (39)$$

where $\bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \in \mathbb{C}^{(N_t-1) \times (N_t-1)}$ is a diagonal matrix containing $N_t - 1$ non-zero eigenvalues of $\mathbf{W}_2$, and $\bar{\mathbf{U}} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times (N_t-1)}$ contains the eigenvectors corresponding to non-zero eigenvalues. Given the facts that $\mathbf{W}_2 = \mathbf{R}_X - \mathbf{W}_1 \succeq \mathbf{0}$, and that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_2) = N_t - 1$, all the eigenvalues in $\bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}}$ should be strictly positive, i.e., $\bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \succ \mathbf{0}$. The orthogonality between $\mathbf{W}_1$ and $\mathbf{W}_2$ yields

$$\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{W}_2 \mathbf{u}_1 = \mathbf{u}_1^H \bar{\mathbf{U}} \bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \bar{\mathbf{U}}^H \mathbf{u}_1 = \mathbf{0} \Rightarrow \bar{\mathbf{U}}^H \mathbf{u}_1 = \mathbf{0}. \quad (40)$$

By letting

$$\lambda_{11} = \mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{u}_1 > 0, \bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} = \text{diag} \{ \lambda_{22}, \lambda_{33}, \dots, \lambda_{N_t N_t} \},$$

$$\mathbf{U} = [\mathbf{u}_1, \bar{\mathbf{U}}], \mathbf{\Lambda} = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_{11} & \mathbf{0} \\ \mathbf{0} & \bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \end{bmatrix}, \quad (41)$$

$\mathbf{R}_X$ can be equivalently written in the form of

$$\mathbf{R}_X = \mathbf{W}_1 + \mathbf{W}_2 = \lambda_{11} \mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^H + \bar{\mathbf{U}} \bar{\mathbf{\Lambda}} \bar{\mathbf{U}}^H = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{\Lambda} \mathbf{U}^H, \quad (42)$$

where $\mathbf{U} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_t \times N_t}$ is a unitary matrix, and $\mathbf{\Lambda}$ is a diagonal matrix with positive diagonal entries. Thus (42) forms an eigenvalue decomposition of $\mathbf{R}_X$, where $\mathbf{u}_1$ is one of the eigenvectors, completing the proof. ■

We note that the structure of the solution in Lemma 2 leads to a maximum ratio transmission (MRT) beamformer, since $\mathbf{u}_1$ is aligned to the direction of $\mathbf{h}_1$. With Lemma 2 at hand, the optimal solution of (37) is attained by the following theorem.

Theorem 3: The optimal solution of problem (37) is

$$\mathbf{W}_1 = \frac{P_T}{N_t} \frac{\mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}, \quad \mathbf{R}_X = \frac{P_T}{N_t} \mathbf{I}_{N_t}, \quad (43)$$

if $\Gamma_1 < \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{N_t \sigma_C^2}$, and

$$\mathbf{W}_1 = \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2 \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^4}, \quad \mathbf{R}_X = \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} \mathbf{u}_i \mathbf{u}_i^H, \quad (44)$$

if $\frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{N_t \sigma_C^2} \leq \Gamma_1 \leq \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{\sigma_C^2}$, where

$$\lambda_{11} = \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}, \quad \lambda_{ii} = \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 - \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 (N_t - 1)}, i = 2, 3, \dots, N_t. \quad (45)$$

Proof: See Appendix D. ■

The closed-form solutions obtained from Theorem 3 naturally satisfy the rank constraints, i.e., $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_1) = 1$. Hence it is also the optimal solution to (34) for the single-user case.

C. Rank-One Optimal Solution of (36) in the Multi-User Case

Although the convex relaxation (36) can be optimally solved using numerical tools, it is not guaranteed to yield rank-one or low-rank solutions. In the case that the solutions are with high ranks, one may obtain the low-rank approximations by employing various methods, e.g., eigenvalue decomposition or Gaussian randomization. Nevertheless, the eigenvalue based approximation might not be accurate given the matrix inverse operation involved in the objective function, and the Gaussian randomization could be computationally expensive. Below we

propose a constructive method to extract the exact rank-one optimum directly from the solutions of the convex-relaxation (36).

Similar to (37), problem (36) can be equivalently formulated as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\{\mathbf{W}_k\}_{k=1}^K, \mathbf{R}_X} \quad & \text{tr}(\mathbf{R}_X^{-1}) \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k (\mathbf{R}_X - \mathbf{W}_k)) \\ & \geq \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2, \forall k, \\ & \text{tr}(\mathbf{R}_X) \leq P_T, \mathbf{R}_X \succeq \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k, \mathbf{W}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k. \end{aligned} \quad (46)$$

By denoting the optimal solution of (46) as $\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$, we have $\text{rank}(\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X) = N_t$, $\text{rank}(\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k) \geq 1, \forall k$. If $\text{rank}(\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k) = 1, \forall k$, then $\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ are also optimal for (34). Otherwise, one can extract the optimal solution of (34) from $\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ by relying on the following theorem.

Theorem 4: Given an optimal solution $\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ of (46), the following $\tilde{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ is also an optimal solution:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{R}}_X = \bar{\mathbf{R}}_X, \quad \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k = \frac{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k \mathbf{Q}_k \bar{\mathbf{W}}_k^H}{\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \bar{\mathbf{W}}_k)}, \forall k \leq K, \quad (47)$$

where $\text{rank}(\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k) = 1, \forall k \leq K$.

Proof: See [11]. $\blacksquare$

The idea behind Theorem 4 is simple, i.e., to preserve the useful signal power of the k -th user by replacing $\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k$ with the rank-one matrix $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k$, and then put the difference between $\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k$ into the covariance matrix of the extra radar beamformer $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{K+1}$. Note that since we do not have a rank constraint on $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{K+1}$, it is possible to “accommodate” the extra ranks in the communication beamforming matrices. The operation in (47) guarantees that $\bar{\mathbf{R}}_X$ is unchanged, and thus the objective value and the transmit power remain the same. Moreover, the useful signal power and the interference are unchanged for each user, which suggests that the resulting SINR is the same as before. Therefore, $\tilde{\mathbf{R}}_X, \{\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ is feasible and optimal. We refer readers to [11] for a detailed proof.

Based on Theorem 4, the first K columns (the communication beamformer $\mathbf{V}_C$) of the optimal beamformer $\tilde{\mathbf{W}}_{DF}$ for the original problem (34) are straightforwardly expressed as

$$\mathbf{w}_k = \frac{\bar{\mathbf{W}}_k \mathbf{h}_k}{\sqrt{\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \bar{\mathbf{W}}_k)}} = (\mathbf{h}_k^H \bar{\mathbf{W}}_k \mathbf{h}_k)^{-1/2} \bar{\mathbf{W}}_k \mathbf{h}_k, \forall k \leq K. \quad (48)$$

Accordingly, the auxiliary beamformer $\mathbf{V}_A$ is attained as a square-root of $\tilde{\mathbf{R}}_X - \sum_{k=1}^K \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k$, i.e.,

$$\mathbf{V}_A \mathbf{V}_A^H = \tilde{\mathbf{R}}_X - \sum_{k=1}^K \tilde{\mathbf{W}}_k, \quad (49)$$

where various approaches can be exploited to extract $\mathbf{V}_A$, e.g., Cholesky decomposition or eigenvalue decomposition.

V. NUMERICAL RESULTS

In this section, we provide numerical results to verify the advantage of the proposed joint beamforming approaches. Without

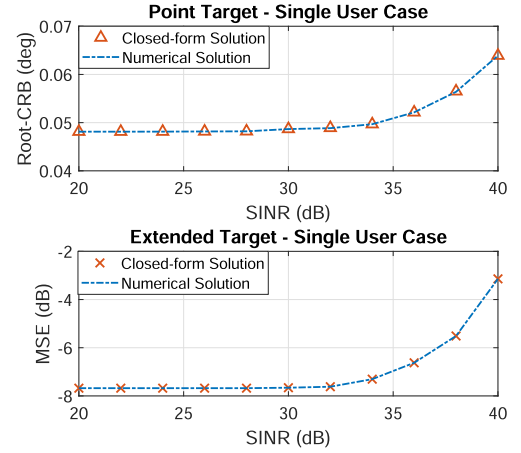


Fig. 2. Closed-form and numerical solutions for the single-user scenario.

loss of generality, we consider a DFRC BS that is equipped with $N_t = 16$ and $N_r = 20$ antennas for its transmitter and receiver. The power budget is $P_T = 30$ dBm, the noise variances are set as $\sigma_C^2 = \sigma_R^2 = 0$ dBm, and the DFRC frame length is set as $L = 30$. The communication channel is set as Rayleigh fading following the standard assumption, i.e., each entry of the channel matrix $\mathbf{H}$ follows i.i.d. complex Gaussian distribution, with zero mean and unit variance.

For the point target scenario, we assume that the target angle is $\theta = 0^\circ$. For the extended target scenario, we assume that the entries of the target response matrix $\mathbf{G}$ are also i.i.d. Gaussian distributed with zero mean and unit variance, which corresponds to a Swerling 1 or Swerling 2 target with Gaussian distributed complex amplitude [36]. This represents the case that there are a large number of reflecting paths from the target to the BS, whose overall summation leads to Gaussian distributed complex path gain thanks to the Central-Limit Theorem. Since for extended target estimation, the CRB is equal to the MSE, we will use MSE to measure the estimation performance of $\mathbf{G}$.

A. Verification of the Closed-Form Solutions

We commence by examining the correctness of the closed-form solutions attained for both point and extended target scenarios, with the presence of a single communication user. The results are shown in Fig. 2, where the radar estimation performance for point and extended targets are shown via the root-CRB of the target angle and the MSE of the target response matrix, respectively. The closed-form solutions match well with their numerical counterparts, which are computed through numerically solving the convex optimization problems (33) and (36) by CVX. Moreover, the increase of the required SINR threshold at the users leads to rising CRB and MSE. Fortunately, the target estimation errors can be maintained at the lowest level for both cases when the required SINR is below 30 dB.

B. Joint Beamforming for Point Target and Multiple Users

Next, we investigate the performance of the proposed joint beamforming method for the scenario of point target and multiple users in Figs. 3–5. Our benchmark techniques are the DFRC beamforming schemes proposed in [11] and [12], where the

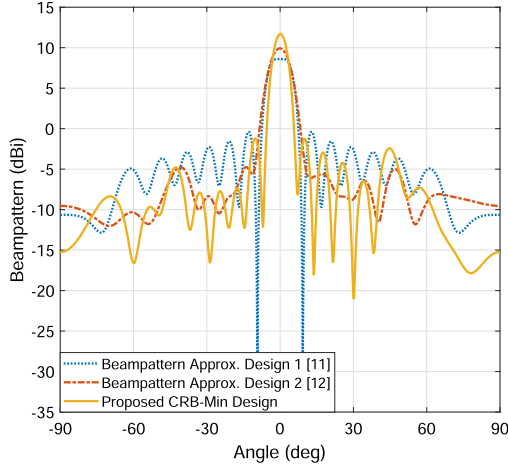


Fig. 3. Beam patterns for the scenario of point target and multiple users, with the methods proposed in [11] and [12] as benchmarks. The number of users is $K = 4$, and the SINR threshold is set as 15 dB.

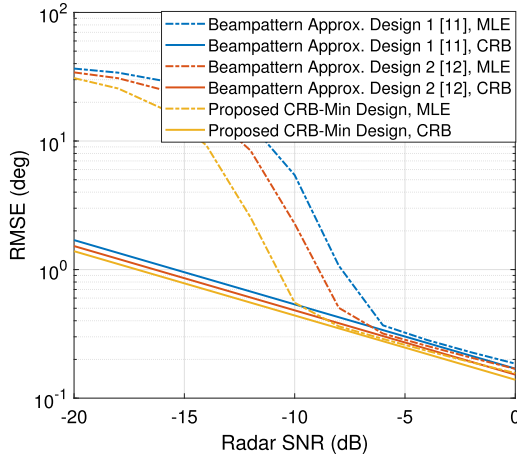


Fig. 4. Target estimation performance in the scenario of point target and multiple users, with the methods proposed in [11] and [12] as benchmarks. The number of users is $K = 4$, and the SINR threshold is set as 15 dB.

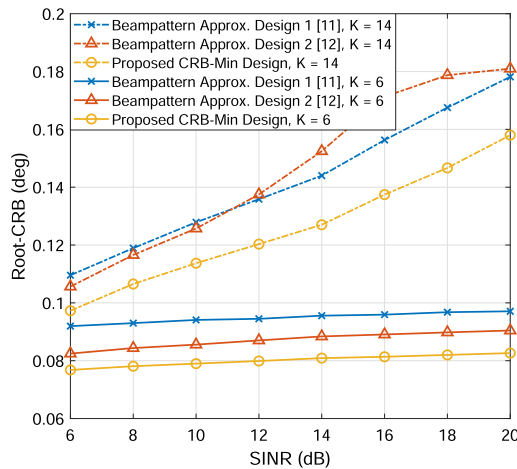


Fig. 5. Tradeoff between radar and communication performance in the scenario of point target and multiple users, with the methods proposed in [11] and [12] as benchmarks. The number of users is set as $K = 6$ and $K = 12$, respectively.

beamforming matrix is designed such that a given radar-only beam pattern is achieved/approximated under individual SINR constraints for downlink communication users. For convenience, we use the term “Beampattern Approx. Design 1,” “Beampattern Approx. Design 2,” and “Proposed CRB-Min Design” to represent the DFRC beamforming technique in [11], [12], and the proposed method, respectively. For the beampattern approximation methods, we define a reference radar-only beam pattern with 3 dB beamwidth of 10° , which is obtained by using the standard MIMO radar beamforming approach in [37].

We first show the resultant beam patterns of the three techniques in Fig. 3, where the number of users and their required SINRs are assumed to be $K = 4$ and $\Gamma_k = 15$ dB, $\forall k$, respectively. It can be seen that all the three beamformers correctly focus their mainlobe towards 0° . We observe that all the obtained beam patterns show random fluctuations in their sidelobe regions, due to the imposed SINR constraints for users. Moreover, the proposed CRB-Min method radiates the highest power towards the target angle among all the three techniques.

The performance for target estimation is explicitly shown in Fig. 4 in terms of the root-MSE (RMSE), with the increase of the receive SNR of the echo signal, which is defined as $\text{SNR}_{\text{radar}} = \frac{|\alpha|^2 L P_T}{\sigma_R^2}$. We obtain the MLE for the target angle via exhaustive grid search over a fine grid defined on $[-90^\circ, 90^\circ]$ [28]. As expected, the RMSE is lower-bounded by the corresponding CRB, and in particular, the CRB is tight and can be achieved by the MLE in the high-SNR regime. It can be seen that the proposed method outperforms both beampattern approximation designs, especially when the SNR is low. This proves that the proposed CRB-Min technique can indeed improve the target estimation performance, as compared to conventional approaches.

In Fig. 5, we consider the performance tradeoff between radar and communication. Owing to the increasing SINR threshold of the users, the CRB for target estimation becomes higher. For a smaller number of users, however, the CRB remains at a low level despite that the user’s SINR is growing. Again, we see that the proposed technique is superior to both beampattern approximation methods in [11] and [12].

C. Joint Beamforming for Extended Target and Multiple Users

We study the scenario of the extended target and multiple users in Figs. 6–7. In Fig. 6, we plot the performance tradeoff between the target estimation MSE and the required SINR for users with $K = 12$ and 6, respectively. The rank-one approximation of the SDR problem (36) is employed as a benchmark, which is obtained by applying the eigenvalue decomposition on the solution of (36).¹ We see that by exploiting Theorem 4, we can indeed acquire the globally optimal solution, which is superior to the conventional rank-one approximation methods, e.g., eigenvalue decomposition. On the other hand, the eigenvalue decomposition fails to generate a favorable performance tradeoff between MSE and SINR, as the trends of the corresponding tradeoff curves

¹Note that the eigenvalue decomposition is not guaranteed to return a feasible solution, despite that we observe that the resultant rank-1 solutions are feasible in most cases. To ensure the effectiveness and fairness of the performance comparison, the infeasible cases are simply dropped without being counted in the Monte-Carlo simulation.

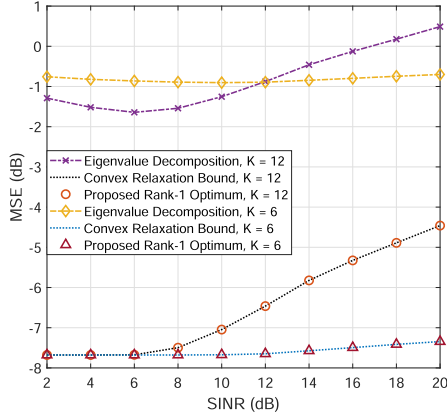


Fig. 6. Tradeoff between target estimation MSE and users' SINR for the scenario of extended target and multiple users, in the cases of $K = 12$ and $K = 6$. The eigenvalue decomposition based rank-one approximation of (36) serves the benchmark.

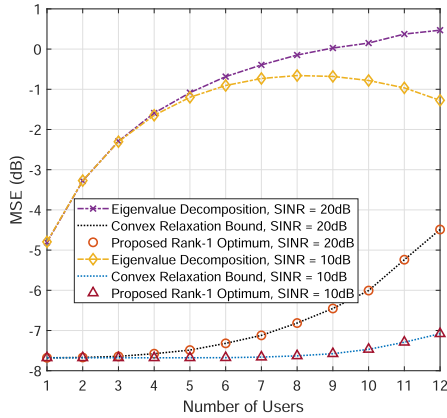


Fig. 7. Target estimation MSE with an increasing user number for the scenario of extended target and multiple users, with SINRs of 20 dB and 10 dB. The eigenvalue decomposition based rank-one approximation of (36) serves as the benchmark.

are not monotonically increasing. More interestingly, the MSE for the proposed rank-one optimum remains at a small level despite that the SINR requirement is increasing, given a moderate number of users, e.g., $K = 6$.

Finally in Fig. 7, we show the impact of the communication user number imposed on the radar estimation performance, with the SINR being set as 20 dB and 10 dB, respectively. It is observed that given an increasing user number, the estimation performance becomes worse. Fortunately, the variation of the MSE can be kept within 1 dB when the required SINR is 10 dB. The results prove again the performance gain of the proposed rank-one optimum over that of the eigenvalue decomposition.

VI. CONCLUSION

In this paper, we proposed beamforming designs for joint radar sensing and multi-user communications, for the scenarios of point and extended targets, respectively. In particular, we formulated optimization problems to minimize the CRB of target estimation by imposing SINR constraints for multiple

communication users. While the considered problems are non-convex, we derived closed-form optimal solutions for both cases in the presence of a single user. In the scenario of multiple users, we designed the DFRC beamformers by exploiting the SDR approach. We then proved that the globally optimal solutions are achievable for both problems. Numerical results demonstrate that the proposed approaches reach the globally optimal solutions, while significantly outperforming the benchmark techniques in terms of target estimation performance.

APPENDIX A PROOF OF LEMMA 1

Consider an optimal solution $\mathbf{w}_1$. We can always express $\mathbf{w}_1$ as

$$\mathbf{w}_1 = a\mathbf{u}_\alpha + b\mathbf{u}_\beta, \quad (50)$$

where $\|\mathbf{u}_\alpha\| = \|\mathbf{u}_\beta\| = 1$, and $\mathbf{u}_\alpha \in \text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}$, $\mathbf{u}_\beta \perp \text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}$, which are the normalized projections of $\mathbf{w}_1$ onto $\text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}$ and its null space, respectively. Since the SINR constraint and the power budget are satisfied, we have

$$a^2 |\mathbf{h}_1^H \mathbf{u}_\alpha|^2 \geq \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \quad \|\mathbf{w}_1\|^2 = a^2 + b^2 \leq P_T, \quad (51)$$

due to the fact that only $\mathbf{u}_\alpha$ contributes to the SINR. Therefore, one can always let $a = \sqrt{P_T}$, $b = 0$, in which case the objective function is strictly increased without violating the constraints. This implies that the optimal $\mathbf{w}_1$ belongs to $\text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}$ [38].

APPENDIX B PROOF OF THEOREM 1

We first show that the power budget of $\mathbf{w}_1$ should always be fully exploited in order to maximize the objective function $|\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{w}_1|^2$. Suppose that there is an optimal solution $\tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1$, such that $\|\tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1\|^2 = \tilde{P} < P_T$. Then we have

$$|\mathbf{h}_1^H \tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2 \geq \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2. \quad (52)$$

Now let us consider another solution $\bar{\mathbf{w}}_1 = \sqrt{\frac{P_T}{\tilde{P}}} \tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1$, which has the power budget of P_T . It can be readily verified that

$$\begin{aligned} |\mathbf{h}_1^H \bar{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2 &= \frac{P_T}{\tilde{P}} |\mathbf{h}_1^H \tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2 > \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \\ |\mathbf{a}^H \bar{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2 &= \frac{P_T}{\tilde{P}} |\mathbf{a}^H \tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2 > |\mathbf{a}^H \tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1|^2, \end{aligned} \quad (53)$$

which implies that $\bar{\mathbf{w}}_1$ is a feasible solution that generates higher objective value than that of $\tilde{\mathbf{w}}_1$. Therefore, the power budget is fully exploited when the optimum is reached.

By noting the above fact, we next consider the case where the SINR constraint is inactive. The solution can be readily obtained by fully allocating the power along the direction of $\mathbf{a}$, i.e., $\mathbf{w}_1 = \sqrt{P_T} \frac{\mathbf{a}}{\|\mathbf{a}\|}$. Now let us discuss the case that the SINR constraint is active. By noting Lemma 1, the optimal $\mathbf{w}_1$ can be expressed as

$$\mathbf{w}_1 = x_1 \mathbf{u}_1 + x_2 \mathbf{a}_u, \quad x_1, x_2 \in \mathbb{C}, \quad (54)$$

since $\text{span}\{\mathbf{a}_u, \mathbf{u}_1\} = \text{span}\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{h}_1\}$. Accordingly, the problem can be reformulated as

$$\max_{x_1, x_2} |x_1 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{u}_1 + x_2 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{a}_u|^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{s.t. } |x_1|^2 \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 &= \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \\ |x_1|^2 + |x_2|^2 &= P_T. \end{aligned} \quad (55)$$

It follows that

$$|x_1|^2 = \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}, \quad |x_2|^2 = P_T - \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}. \quad (56)$$

To maximize the objective function, the phases of x_1 and x_2 should be the opposite of that of $\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{u}_1$ and $\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{a}_u$, respectively, i.e., x_1 and x_2 should be aligned with the directions of $\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{u}_1$ and $\mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{a}_u$. This results in the expressions in (29), which completes the proof.

APPENDIX C PROOF OF THEOREM 2

Let us define the dual variables for problem (33), which are $\{\mu_1, \mu_2, \dots, \mu_K, \mu_T\}$ that are associated with $K + 1$ linear constraints, and $\{\mathbf{Z}_1, \mathbf{Z}_2, \dots, \mathbf{Z}_K, \mathbf{Z}_P\} \succeq \mathbf{0}$ that are associated with $K + 1$ semidefinite constraints. By assuming that the optimality is reached with $\{\mu_1, \mu_2, \dots, \mu_K, \mu_T\}$, $\{\mathbf{Z}_1, \mathbf{Z}_2, \dots, \mathbf{Z}_K, \mathbf{Z}_P\}$ and $\{\mathbf{W}_1, \mathbf{W}_2, \dots, \mathbf{W}_K\}$, the following complementary conditions hold true

$$\begin{aligned} -\mu_k \left(\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_i) - \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2 \right) &= 0, \\ \mu_k &\geq 0, \forall k, \\ \mu_T \left(\sum_{k=1}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{W}_k) - P_T \right) &= 0, \mu_T \geq 0, \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_k \mathbf{W}_k) &= 0, \mathbf{Z}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k, \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_P \mathbf{P}) &= 0, \mathbf{Z}_P \succeq \mathbf{0}, \end{aligned} \quad (57)$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{P} &\triangleq \begin{bmatrix} \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) - t & \text{tr}(\dot{\mathbf{A}}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \\ \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \dot{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{R}_X) & \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^H \mathbf{A} \mathbf{R}_X) \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{a} + \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H \mathbf{R}_X \dot{\mathbf{a}} - t & \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{R}_X \dot{\mathbf{a}} \\ \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{a} & \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \mathbf{a}^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{a} \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (58)$$

In (58), the second equality holds due to the orthogonality property in (22). Moreover, the Lagrangian can be formulated as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L} &= -t - \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_P \mathbf{P}) - \sum_{k=1}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \\ &\sum_{k=1}^K \mu_k \left(\text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \sum_{i=1, i \neq k}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_i) - \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2 \right) \\ &+ \mu_T \left(\sum_{k=1}^K \text{tr}(\mathbf{W}_k) - P_T \right). \end{aligned} \quad (59)$$

Let

$$\mathbf{Z}_P = \begin{bmatrix} \phi & \beta \\ \beta^* & \gamma \end{bmatrix} \succeq \mathbf{0}. \quad (60)$$

The derivative of the Lagrangian at the optimum can be given as

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial t} &= -1 + \phi = 0 \Leftrightarrow \phi = 1, \\ \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \mathbf{W}_k} &= -\mathbf{F} - \mathbf{Z}_k - \mu_k (1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k \\ &+ \sum_{i=1}^K \mu_i \Gamma_i \mathbf{Q}_i + \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} = \mathbf{0}, \forall k, \end{aligned} \quad (61)$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{F} &\triangleq \frac{\partial \text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_P \mathbf{P})}{\partial \mathbf{W}_k} \\ &= \left(\phi \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + \gamma \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \right) \mathbf{a} \mathbf{a}^H + \phi \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \dot{\mathbf{a}} \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H \\ &+ 2 \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \text{Re}(\beta \mathbf{a} \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H) \\ &= [\mathbf{a} \ \dot{\mathbf{a}}] \begin{bmatrix} \phi \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + \gamma \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \beta \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \\ \beta^* \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \phi \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{a}^H \\ \dot{\mathbf{a}}^H \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (62)$$

Since $\phi = 1$, it follows that $\mathbf{Z}_P \neq \mathbf{0}$. By noting that $\mathbf{P} \neq \mathbf{0}$, both $\mathbf{Z}_P$ and $\mathbf{P}$ should be singular matrices to satisfy $\text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_P \mathbf{P}) = 0$. For $\mathbf{Z}_P \succeq \mathbf{0}$, this implies

$$\phi - |\beta|^2 \gamma^{-1} = 1 - |\beta|^2 \gamma^{-1} = 0 \Leftrightarrow \gamma = |\beta|^2. \quad (63)$$

By leveraging the relationship in (63), it can be verified that

$$\begin{aligned} &\begin{bmatrix} \phi \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + \gamma \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \beta \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \\ \beta^* \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \phi \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} \|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + |\beta|^2 \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \beta \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \\ \beta^* \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 & \|\mathbf{b}\|^2 \end{bmatrix} \succcurlyeq \mathbf{0}. \end{aligned} \quad (64)$$

Moreover, since $\mathbf{a} \perp \dot{\mathbf{a}}$, we have $\mathbf{F} \succeq \mathbf{0}$, $\text{rank}(\mathbf{F}) = 2$. The two non-zero eigenvalues of $\mathbf{F}$, denoted as λ_1 and λ_2 , are shown in (67) at the bottom of the next page. It can be readily observed that $\lambda_1 = \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{F}) > \lambda_2$ regardless of the value of β , under the condition that $N_t \neq N_r$, which is satisfied in general for MIMO radar where N_r is chosen to be larger than N_t .

Given the tightly coupled relation between $\mathbf{W}_k$ and $\mathbf{Z}_k$, i.e., $\text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_k \mathbf{W}_k) = 0$, the rank property of $\mathbf{W}_k$ can be revealed through analyzing the rank of $\mathbf{Z}_k$. From (61) we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Z}_k &= \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \left(\mathbf{F} - \sum_{i=1}^K \mu_i \Gamma_i \mathbf{Q}_i \right) - \mu_k (1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k \\ &\triangleq \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \bar{\mathbf{F}} - \mu_k (1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k, \end{aligned} \quad (65)$$

where $\bar{\mathbf{F}} \triangleq \mathbf{F} - \sum_{i=1}^K \mu_i \Gamma_i \mathbf{Q}_i$.

According to (65), the rank property of $\mathbf{Z}_k$ highly depends on the structure of $\mathbf{F}$, which is due to the extra Schur complement structure of the CRB matrix. In fact, if $\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{0}$, (65) reduces to the conventional KKT analysis for communication-only beamforming optimization, where $\mathbf{Z}_k$ is guaranteed to have a rank of $N_t - 1$. In that case, it is easy to see that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) \leq 1$. However, the existence of $\mathbf{F}$ makes the rank analysis for $\mathbf{Z}_k$ highly non-trivial. In what follows, we provide a thorough investigation and a rigorous proof of the rank-1 property of $\mathbf{W}_k$.

Note that $\mathbf{Z}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}$ implies that

$$\mu_T \geq \lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}} + \mu_k (1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k), \forall k, \quad (66)$$

where $\lambda_{\max}(\cdot)$ represents the largest eigenvalue of the input matrix. By observing $\text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_k \mathbf{W}_k) = 0$ from (57), $\mathbf{Z}_k$ must be singular since $\mathbf{W}_k \succeq \mathbf{0}$, $\mathbf{W}_k \neq \mathbf{0}$. Therefore we have

$$\mu_T = \lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}} + \mu_k(1 + \Gamma_k)\mathbf{Q}_k), \forall k. \quad (68)$$

Apparently, the rank of $\mathbf{Z}_k$ strongly depends on the value of $\mu_k \geq 0$. Let us split the index set $\mathcal{K} = \{1, 2, \dots, K\}$ into two subsets, i.e.,

$$\mathcal{K}_1 = \{k | \mu_k > 0, \forall k\}, \quad \mathcal{K}_2 = \{k | \mu_k = 0, \forall k\}. \quad (69)$$

We have $\mathcal{K} = \mathcal{K}_1 \cup \mathcal{K}_2$. Next, we discuss the rank of $\mathbf{Z}_k$ and $\mathbf{W}_k$ under the following cases, which cover all the possible values that $\mu_k, \forall k$ may take.

1) **Case I:** $|\mathcal{K}_1| = 0$.

In this case, we have $\mu_k = 0, \forall k$, and all the SINR constraints are ineffective. It follows that

$$\mathbf{Z}_k = \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \mathbf{F} \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k. \quad (70)$$

Again, $\mathbf{Z}_k$ must be singular to ensure a non-zero $\mathbf{W}_k$, which leads to

$$\mu_T = \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{F}) = \lambda_1. \quad (71)$$

Since $\lambda_1 > \lambda_2$, it holds immediately that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{Z}_k) = N_t - 1, \text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1, \forall k$.

2) **Case II:** $|\mathcal{K}_1| = 1$.

In this case, only one μ_k is strictly positive, and the remaining ones are zero. Without loss of generality, let $\mu_1 > 0, \mu_k = 0, \forall k \geq 2$ for notational convenience. We can express $\mathbf{Z}_k$ as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Z}_1 &= \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \mathbf{F} - \mu_1 \mathbf{Q}_1 \succeq \mathbf{0}, \\ \mathbf{Z}_k &= \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \mathbf{F} + \mu_1 \Gamma_1 \mathbf{Q}_1 \succeq \mathbf{0}, \forall k > 1. \end{aligned} \quad (72)$$

It follows that

$$\mu_T = \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{F} + \mu_1 \mathbf{Q}_1) = \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{F} - \mu_1 \Gamma_1 \mathbf{Q}_1). \quad (73)$$

Given the semidefiniteness of $\mathbf{Q}_1 = \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H$, (73) holds only if $\mathbf{f}_{\max}^H \mathbf{h}_1 = 0$, where $\mathbf{f}_{\max}$ is the eigenvector of $\mathbf{F}$ corresponding to the largest eigenvalue λ_1 . This also implies that

$$\mu_T = \lambda_1 \Leftrightarrow \text{rank}(\mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \mathbf{F}) = N_t - 1. \quad (74)$$

Hence, we have

$$\begin{aligned} N_t - 2 &\leq \text{rank}(\mathbf{Z}_1) \leq N_t - 1, \\ \text{rank}(\mathbf{Z}_k) &= N_t - 1, \forall k \geq 2. \end{aligned} \quad (75)$$

By recalling $\text{tr}(\mathbf{Z}_k \mathbf{W}_k) = 0$, $\mathbf{W}_k$ should be within the null-space of $\mathbf{Z}_k$, which is

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{Z}_1) &= \text{span}\{\mathbf{h}_1, \mathbf{f}_{\max}\}, \\ \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{Z}_k) &= \text{span}\{\mathbf{f}_{\max}\}, \forall k \geq 2. \end{aligned} \quad (76)$$

Accordingly, $\mathbf{W}_k$ can be expressed as

$$\mathbf{W}_1 = a_1 \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H + b_1 \mathbf{f}_{\max} \mathbf{f}_{\max}^H, \quad \mathbf{W}_k = b_k \mathbf{f}_{\max} \mathbf{f}_{\max}^H, \forall k \geq 2, \quad (77)$$

where $a_k \geq 0, b_k \geq 0, \forall k$.

If $a_1 = 0$, then $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1, \forall k$ holds. Otherwise if $a_1 > 0$, let

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{W}'_1 &= a_1 \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H, \quad \mathbf{W}'_2 = (b_1 + b_2) \mathbf{f}_{\max} \mathbf{f}_{\max}^H, \\ \mathbf{W}'_k &= \mathbf{W}_k, \forall k \geq 3. \end{aligned} \quad (78)$$

It can be readily verified that if $\{\mathbf{W}_k\}_{k=1}^K$ is an optimal solution for problem (33), then $\{\mathbf{W}'_k\}_{k=1}^K$ is a rank-one optimal solution, due to the fact that the following conditions hold

$$\sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}'_k = \sum_{k=1}^K \mathbf{W}_k = \mathbf{R}_X, \quad (79a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + \Gamma_2) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_2 \mathbf{W}'_2) - \Gamma_2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_2 \mathbf{R}_X) \\ \geq (1 + \Gamma_2) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_2 \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_2 \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_2 \mathbf{R}_X) \geq \Gamma_2 \sigma_C^2, \end{aligned} \quad (79b)$$

$$\begin{aligned} (1 + \Gamma_k) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}'_k) - \Gamma_k \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{R}_X) \\ = (1 + \Gamma_k) \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{W}_k) - \Gamma_k \text{tr}(\mathbf{Q}_k \mathbf{R}_X) \geq \Gamma_k \sigma_C^2, \\ \forall k \neq 2. \end{aligned} \quad (79c)$$

Note that the objective value does not change due to (79a). Moreover, (79b) and (79c) guarantee the feasibility of $\{\mathbf{W}'_k\}_{k=1}^K$. Therefore, in Case II, rank-one optimal solutions can always be attained.

3) **Case III:** $|\mathcal{K}_1| \geq 2$.

In this case, we observe that there are at least two positive μ_k , and the remaining ones might be zero or positive. Let $M \triangleq |\mathcal{K}_1| \geq 2$, and assume, without loss of generality, that

$$\mathcal{K}_1 = \{1, 2, \dots, M\}, \quad \mathcal{K}_2 = \{M+1, M+2, \dots, K\}. \quad (80)$$

Let $\tilde{\mathbf{H}} = [\mathbf{h}_1, \mathbf{h}_2, \dots, \mathbf{h}_M]^H$, $\tilde{\mathbf{A}} = [\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{a}]$, and define $\mathbf{D} \triangleq \tilde{\mathbf{H}} \tilde{\mathbf{A}}$. The following lemma holds.

Lemma 3: If $\mathbf{D}$ is of full column rank, then $\mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \bar{\mathbf{F}} \succ \mathbf{0}$.

Proof: We shall prove this lemma by contradiction. First we note that $\mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \bar{\mathbf{F}} \succeq \mathbf{0}$ holds from (66), given the non-negativity of $\mu_k(1 + \Gamma_k)\mathbf{Q}_k$. It follows that

$$\mu_T \geq \lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}}). \quad (81)$$

Now suppose that $\mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \bar{\mathbf{F}} \succ \mathbf{0}$ does not hold, and hence $\mu_T = \lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}})$. Let $\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}$ be the eigenvector of $\bar{\mathbf{F}}$ corresponding to $\lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}})$, i.e.,

$$\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}^H \bar{\mathbf{F}} \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} = \lambda_{\max}(\bar{\mathbf{F}}) = \mu_T, \quad \|\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}\|^2 = 1. \quad (82)$$

We then have

$$\begin{aligned} \mu_T + \mu_k(1 + \Gamma_k) \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}^H \mathbf{Q}_k \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} \\ = \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}^H (\bar{\mathbf{F}} + \mu_k(1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k) \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda_1 &= \frac{N_t \left(\|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + |\beta|^2 N_r \right) + N_r \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2 + \sqrt{\left(N_t \left(\|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + |\beta|^2 N_r \right) - N_r \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2 \right)^2 + 4|\beta|^2 N_t N_r^2 \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2}}{2}, \\ \lambda_2 &= \frac{N_t \left(\|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + |\beta|^2 N_r \right) + N_r \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2 - \sqrt{\left(N_t \left(\|\dot{\mathbf{b}}\|^2 + |\beta|^2 N_r \right) - N_r \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2 \right)^2 + 4|\beta|^2 N_t N_r^2 \|\dot{\mathbf{a}}\|^2}}{2}. \end{aligned} \quad (67)$$

$$\leq \lambda_{\max} (\bar{\mathbf{F}} + \mu_k (1 + \Gamma_k) \mathbf{Q}_k) = \mu_T, \quad (83)$$

where the first equality holds from the assumption, and the last inequality in (83) holds by the definition of the largest eigenvalue. Given $\mu_k > 0, \forall k \leq M$, we have

$$\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max}^H \mathbf{Q}_k \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} = 0 \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{h}_k^H \bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} = 0, \forall k \leq M. \quad (84)$$

Due to the definitions of $\mathbf{F}$ and $\bar{\mathbf{F}}$, we know that

$$\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} \in \text{span} \{ \mathbf{a}, \dot{\mathbf{a}}, \mathbf{h}_1, \dots, \mathbf{h}_M \}. \quad (85)$$

By both (84) and (85), we see that

$$\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} \in \text{span} \{ \mathbf{a}, \dot{\mathbf{a}} \}. \quad (86)$$

Suppose that $\bar{\mathbf{f}}_{\max} = f_1 \mathbf{a} + f_2 \dot{\mathbf{a}}$. From (84) we have

$$\mathbf{h}_k^H [\mathbf{a}, \dot{\mathbf{a}}] \begin{bmatrix} f_1 \\ f_2 \end{bmatrix} = 0, \forall k \leq M \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{D} \begin{bmatrix} f_1 \\ f_2 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{0}. \quad (87)$$

Hence, $\mathbf{D}$ is not of full column rank, which leads to contradiction. This completes the proof. ■

Corollary 1: If $|\mathcal{K}_1| \geq 2$, and $\mathbf{D}$ is of full column rank, then $|\mathcal{K}_1| = K$, and $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1, \forall k$.

Proof: In light of Lemma 3, for those $k \in \mathcal{K}_2$, we have

$$\mathbf{Z}_k = \mu_T \mathbf{I}_{N_t} - \bar{\mathbf{F}} \succ \mathbf{0}, \forall k \geq M + 1. \quad (88)$$

This suggests that $\mathbf{W}_k = \mathbf{0}, \forall k \geq M + 1$, which is infeasible. Therefore, all μ_k should be positive to ensure that $\mathbf{Z}_k$ is singular, in which case $|\mathcal{K}_2| = 0$, and thereby $|\mathcal{K}_1| = K$. In this case, all $\mathbf{Z}_k$ can be expressed as in (65), with $\mu_k > 0, \forall k$. As a consequence, $\text{rank}(\mathbf{Z}_k) = N_t - 1, \forall k$, as each of them is obtained by subtracting a rank-one semidefinite matrix from a full-rank positive-definite matrix. This implies that $\text{rank}(\mathbf{W}_k) = 1, \forall k$, which completes the proof. ■

By Corollary 1, in Case III we have rank-one solutions if $\mathbf{D}$ is of full column rank. Given the above discussions on all the three cases, it holds true that if $\mathbf{H}\bar{\mathbf{A}}$ is of full column rank, solving problem (33) always yields rank-one solutions, which completes the proof of Theorem 2.

APPENDIX D PROOF OF THEOREM 3

In light of Lemma 2, and by noting (42), the optimization problem (37) can be equivalently formulated as

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{\{\lambda_{ii}\}_{i=1}^{N_t}} \quad & \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii}^{-1} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \lambda_{11} \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 \geq \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2, \\ & \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} \leq P_T, \lambda_{ii} \geq 0, \forall i. \end{aligned} \quad (89)$$

Problem (89) is convex. Note that we should have $\frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \leq \lambda_{11} \leq P_T \Leftrightarrow \Gamma_1 \leq \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{\sigma_C^2}$ for ensuring the feasibility of the problem. In order to find a closed-form solution, we formulate the Lagrangian of the problem as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{L} = \quad & \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii}^{-1} + \omega \left(-\lambda_{11} + \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \right) \\ & + \mu \left(\sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} - P_T \right) - \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \eta_i \lambda_{ii}, \end{aligned} \quad (90)$$

where ω, μ , and $\eta_i, \forall i$ are the dual variables. Accordingly, the Karush-Kuhn-Tucker (KKT) conditions can be given as

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \lambda_{11}} = -\lambda_{11}^{-2} - \omega + \mu - \eta_1 = 0, \quad (91a)$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \lambda_{ii}} = -\lambda_{ii}^{-2} + \mu - \eta_i = 0, \quad i = 2, 3, \dots, N_t, \quad (91b)$$

$$\omega \left(-\lambda_{11} + \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \right) = 0, \omega \geq 0, \lambda_{11} \geq \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}, \quad (91c)$$

$$\mu \left(\sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} - P_T \right) = 0, \mu \geq 0, \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} \leq P_T, \quad (91d)$$

$$\eta_i \lambda_{ii} = 0, \eta_i \geq 0, \lambda_{ii} \geq 0. \quad (91e)$$

It can be immediately observed that $\eta_i = 0, \forall i$, since $\lambda_{ii} > 0, \forall i$. Therefore, (91 a) and (91 b) can be rewritten as

$$\lambda_{11}^{-2} = \mu - \omega, \quad (92a)$$

$$\lambda_{ii}^{-2} = \mu, \quad i = 2, 3, \dots, N_t. \quad (92b)$$

From (92 b) we see that $\mu > 0$, which indicates that the power budget should always be reached, i.e., $\sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} = P_T$. We then investigate the value of ω . Suppose that $\omega = 0$, which suggests $\lambda_{11} > \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}$, i.e., the SINR constraint is inactive. In this case, we have $\lambda_{ii}^{-2} = \mu, \forall i$. Hence, all λ_{ii} should be the same, which is

$$\lambda_{ii} = \frac{P_T}{N_t}, \forall i. \quad (93)$$

By using (93) and Lemma 2 we obtain the optimal solution as

$$\mathbf{W}_1 = \frac{P_T}{N_t} \frac{\mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}, \mathbf{R}_X = \frac{P_T}{N_t} \mathbf{I}_{N_t}. \quad (94)$$

Note that this requires that the following condition holds

$$\frac{P_T}{N_t} > \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2} \Leftrightarrow \Gamma_1 < \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{N_t \sigma_C^2}. \quad (95)$$

On the other hand, if $\omega > 0$, the SINR constraint is active and we have $\lambda_{11} = \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}$. To satisfy the power constraint, it holds that $\sum_{i=2}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} = P_T - \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}$. By noting (92 b), we arrive at

$$\lambda_{ii} = \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 - \Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2 (N_t - 1)}, i = 2, 3, \dots, N_t. \quad (96)$$

Hence, for the case that $\Gamma_1 > \frac{P_T \|\mathbf{h}_1\|^2}{N_t \sigma_C^2}$, we have the optimal solution in the form of

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{W}_1 &= (\mathbf{u}_1^H \mathbf{R}_X \mathbf{u}_1) \mathbf{u}_1 \mathbf{u}_1^H = \frac{\Gamma_1 \sigma_C^2 \mathbf{h}_1 \mathbf{h}_1^H}{\|\mathbf{h}_1\|^4}, \\ \mathbf{R}_X &= \sum_{i=1}^{N_t} \lambda_{ii} \mathbf{u}_i \mathbf{u}_i^H, \end{aligned} \quad (97)$$

which completes the proof.

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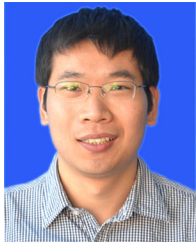
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